

MSI NX7800 GTX 256 MB

The NX7800 GTX is a spanking new graphics card from MSI. It is based on the nVidia GeForce 7800 GTX. The card has 256 MB of GDDR3 RAM and dual DVI outputs. It is also ViVo capable. It performed on par with the 7800

GTX-based card from XFX which we had tested earlier, but fell a little behind in 3DMark03 and 3DMark05.

Still, the card is blazingly fast—faster than almost all cards currently available.

The card supports Shader Model 3.0 and has 24 pipelines—the highest yet in the graphics industry—so all the latest games can be played on this card in their full glory. The bundled game is

Chronicles of Riddick: Butcher's Bay. At Rs 36,000, this card is out of the reach of most, but die-hard gaming addicts should start saving!

Company **Micro-Star International**

Price **Rs 36,000**

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Web site **www.msi-india.com**

Rating



Kodak EasyShare V530

Little Wonder

The V530 is a shiny little 35 mm digicam. It's not tiny on features though, and boasts of 5 megapixels with 3x optical and 4x digital zoom and auto-focus. What's more, it can even record video at 640 x 480.

The Kodak EasyShare V530 connects to a Kodak EasyShare dock for file transfer and printing. It uses USB 2.0 for PC transfer, and features PictBridge. The photographs we took were crisp, and the colours perfectly reproduced. Thanks to the powerful inbuilt flash, the photographs were just as brilliant even when we shot in total darkness.

Unfortunately, internal memory is a paltry 16 MB—which means that the cost of an SD or MMC card should be added to the price tag.

Company **Kodak India Pvt Ltd**

Price **Rs 15,999**

Phone **1600-224949**

Web site **www.kodakindia.com**

Rating



New & Notable

Logitech G7 Laser Cordless Mouse

For When You Want To Win

The G7 mouse, which is the top-of-the-line mouse from Logitech right now, is a remarkable product. It is arguably the only gaming mouse with features that make ordinary mice look like relics.

The G7 features a super-high resolution 2000 dpi laser engine that processes an astounding 6.4 megapixels per second. To add to precision, it features a full-speed, bi-directional sampling rate of 500 reports per second.

A 2.4 GHz RF USB dongle connects the mouse to the PC, and it can plug into either a USB port or a battery charging station that in turn connects to the PC's USB port. The instant access to the three sensitivity levels of 400, 800 and 2000 dpi while gaming allows easy shifting between pixel-precise targeting and fast-twitch manoeuvres. The cool thing is that all this is done without any need to install drivers! The polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE) gaming feet facilitate smooth gliding, which add to the ergonomics.

The sleep mode in this mouse has been deliberately disabled to avoid even a split-second delay between the mouse switching On from the Off state, which can make a difference between fragging and getting fragged. This obviously means that the batteries drain quickly, and here is where the bundled twin Lithium-ion battery packs come in handy. We found that the batteries drained in

two days, which consisted of eight hours of daily use, of which three were specifically for gaming at 800 dpi. There is a five-level battery indicator which lets you know when the ammo, umm, the battery, needs to be reloaded.

The only patently bad thing about this mouse is that the middle mouse button, which also has side-scrolling, is particularly hard to press and can cause fatigue. The workaround for this is to use the Setpoint software from Logitech to program the thumb button as the middle button and get used to it. Another weakness is that it is aimed at right-handed people: left-handed people will have a hard time getting comfortable with it.

Even with these weaknesses, the G7 is a formidable weapon for gamers, who will probably not mind the price tag of Rs 6,495. After all, the mouse, like we said, can make all the difference in a deathmatch!

Company **Logitech Electronic India Pvt Ltd**

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Rating

